

The 6:15

SATURDAY · AUGUST 29, 2026

NO. 8

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS) · WEEKEND FORMAT

Ahead

Fri 9/4 Aug. jobs report, 8:30a (BLS) · Mon 9/7 Labor Day, markets closed · Tue 9/8 Canada's dollar-for-dollar retaliatory tariffs on ~\$27.6B of U.S. imports (steel, dairy, appliances, ag equipment, pulp/paper, electronics) take effect · Fri 9/11 Aug. CPI, 8:30a · Wed 9/16 FOMC decision — Sept. hike odds 57-59% (CME FedWatch), up from 34-35% Thu, after Friday's Warsh keynote.

Developing

Anthropic's public S-1 still unfiled as of press time; still targeting an Oct. Nasdaq listing at a reported **~\$2T valuation, not confirmed** vs. its \$965B May Series H. No verified primary, rocket-launch or VC-round item fell in this window this run.

METRICS · WEEKEND FORMAT, ET UNLESS NOTED

Equities

Fri close: S&P 500 7,711.76 (-0.25%), Dow 53,559.99 (-0.02%), Nasdaq 26,402.42 (-0.52%) — all gave back Thursday's Nvidia rally after Warsh's hawkish keynote. VIX 14.43 (-0.55%). Asia Fri: Nikkei 66,405.56 (+0.41%), Hang Seng 25,584.79 (+0.07%); Europe closed higher Fri (**exact Stoxx 600/DAX prints not verified this run**).

Rates/Oil/FX

2Y 4.38% (+12bp Fri — largest one-day, post-Jackson-Hole-speech move this century per Yahoo Finance), 10Y 4.72% (+4bp), 30Y 5.21%. DXY 99.47 (+0.31%). Brent ~\$88/bbl Fri (**no clean settle located**), WTI \$82.82 Thu settle (-0.86%, no fresher print found). Gold holding above \$4,600/oz (**prints disagree, \$4,608-\$4,631**). Retail gas \$4.0898/gal natl. avg (AAA, 8/28).

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure

Day 181 (straits.live, as of 8/29 1017Z)

Transits	PortWatch's latest (8/23): 3/day vs. ~85/day pre-crisis baseline — 4% of normal volume. Kpler: 121 crossings 17-23 Aug (vs. 118 prior week); just 5 tankers Tue 8/26 vs. its own 10-day average of 15. Counts diverge by an order of magnitude
Strikes	None recorded past 24h (straits.live) — first quiet window in recent issues. Metro Venetian (8/24, off Ash Shishah) still unattributed; JMIC's 8/25 update cites continued IRGC harassment, no strike claim.
Dark tankers	65 of 240 screened (27%) show AIS gaps vs. 7-day baseline 49.0 (straits.live) — larger sample than last issue's 156, not directly comparable
War-risk premium	~\$10.0M/VLCC transit, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live) — unchanged from Thu

Methodology, unchanged: Kpler's near-real-time AIS daily counts, Lloyd's List's slower weekly aggregation, and PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Beat Red Sox 1-0 Fri 8/28. 76-58, 2nd AL East (4.0 GB Tampa Bay), holds AL's No. 1 Wild Card.
Knicks	Hart extension (3-yr/\$60-62M eyed) still unsigned — unchanged since Thu.
Northwestern	Named six team captains 8/26 ahead of Sept. 5 opener.

LEAD

FIRST TEST

Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote turns hawkish; markets reprice for a September hike in a single session

Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh delivered his first Jackson Hole keynote Friday, and the market's read was unambiguous: hawkish. "The responsibility for 65 months of sustained, elevated inflation sits squarely with the central bank," Warsh told the Economic Policy

Symposium, adding that while "this summer's readings were better than expected, they do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved." He said the Fed's "predominant focus right now should be on prices," with inflation — by the Fed's preferred gauge, running near 3.7% over the past year — still "above our 2% target," even as he judged the economy at "full employment" and said he was "impressed" by its overall performance. [NEW]

Mechanism: Warsh again declined to offer forward guidance, framing his approach as "a discipline, not a decision" — but traders didn't need a decision to reprice. CME FedWatch odds of a 25bp hike at the Sept. 16 FOMC meeting jumped to 57-59% from 34-35% Thursday, the sharpest single-day repricing of Fed expectations since Warsh took the chair in May. The 2-year Treasury yield — the tenor most sensitive to near-term Fed policy — jumped roughly 12bp on the session to 4.38%, a move Yahoo Finance's markets desk called the largest one-day, post-Jackson-Hole-speech move in the yield this century. The 10-year rose a smaller 4bp to 4.72%, and the 30-year barely moved, to 5.21% — a bear-flattening pattern consistent with markets pricing near-term tightening without revising up long-run inflation or growth expectations. [NEW]

Equities gave back Thursday's Nvidia-driven gains: the S&P 500 fell 0.25% to 7,711.76, the Nasdaq dropped 0.52% to 26,402.42, and the Dow eased 0.02% to 53,559.99 — a session Sevens Report's Tom Essaye had flagged in advance as a "solid pullback" risk if Warsh failed to offer clarity on the rate path. He didn't, deliberately: Warsh's framework rejects the forward-guidance regime his predecessors used, on the theory that it constrains the Fed's flexibility to respond to incoming data. The VIX barely moved (14.43, -0.55%), and the dollar index firmed to 99.47 (+0.31%) — a

muted-vol, stronger-dollar reaction consistent with a hawkish repricing rather than a growth scare. [read: the market isn't pricing a policy mistake, it's pricing a policy fight — Warsh is the first Fed chair of this cycle to treat "full employment" as license to hike rather than a reason for caution, and traders are taking him at his word rather than assuming he's bluffing into a still-soft labor market.]

The second-order consequence is where this collides with Thursday's jobless-claims data and Bessent's Treasury buybacks. Initial claims for the week ended Aug. 22 came in at 203,000, below the roughly 208,000 consensus and the prior week's upwardly revised 207,000 — a labor market still showing no cracks, which is exactly the data point Warsh cited as clearing the way to treat inflation, not employment, as the binding constraint. [fact] That leaves the Sept. 4 jobs report and the Sept. 11 CPI print as the two data points standing between here and the Sept. 16 decision — either could reverse Friday's repricing as easily as it happened. [read] Treasury Secretary Bessent's expanded long-bond buybacks, which helped pull long yields down through much of August, look increasingly at odds with a Fed chair now actively talking up the short end — a policy mismatch between the Fed and Treasury that FX desks flagged before Friday and that Friday's bear-flattener makes harder to ignore. [continuity: same tension flagged in Thursday's issue, now visible in the yield curve itself rather than just in commentary]

POLITICS

Federal Reserve Governor Lisa Cook's attorney met the White House's Wednesday deadline with a reply that went on offense: rather than simply denying Trump's revived mortgage-fraud allegations, the letter cited reporting that Trump himself, Treasury

Secretary Bessent and Attorney General Todd Blanche have each also claimed multiple primary residences on mortgage paperwork at the same time. [NEW] The tactic doesn't change the legal posture — Cook still needs the allegations found meritless or the removal effort blocked again, as the Supreme Court did once already this year, with argument now set for January — but it raises the political cost of a second removal attempt built on conduct the White House's own officials share. No response from the White House had surfaced as of press time. The timing lands the same week as Warsh's Jackson Hole debut, crowding two separate Fed-credibility stories — one about who sets rates, one about who gets to stay on the board — into the same news cycle without either resolving.

BUSINESS

Marvell reported fiscal Q2 revenue of \$2.739 billion Thursday after the close, up 36.5% y/y and about 1.2% above the \$2.71-2.72 billion consensus; non-GAAP EPS of \$0.94 was in line with estimates, and Data Center revenue accelerated to 46% y/y growth. The number that mattered more than the backward-looking beat: Q3 guidance of roughly \$3.15 billion, about 4% above what analysts had modeled. [NEW] Between Nvidia's \$108B Q3 guide Wednesday and Marvell's \$3.15B guide Thursday, the AI-capex trade broadened beyond the single name it had been concentrated in through most of August — a second confirmation in one week that hyperscaler capacity orders, not just Nvidia's own backlog, are still accelerating.

GEOPOLITICS

Russian and Ukrainian strikes on economic infrastructure continued into the weekend. Russia's Defense Ministry said it struck a transshipment terminal at Mykolaiv on Aug. 29, plus fuel-refueling and unloading points, briefly knocking out the port city's public-transit power; separately, Russian missiles hit Kyiv logistics warehouses Moscow says stored components for Ukraine's domestically produced Flamingo cruise missile — the weapon Kyiv has used against Russian oil terminals and logistics hubs. [NEW] Ukraine's own drone campaign killed three and injured nine in Russia's Belgorod region. [fact] Both sides are now explicitly targeting the other's fuel and logistics infrastructure rather than front-line positions, continuing the escalation flagged in a prior issue — no new diplomatic channel reported active this run. Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar; no movement on export controls surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Friday-into-Saturday was the first 24-hour window in recent issues with no strikes logged against Gulf shipping (straits.live, as of 1017Z Sat) — a genuine quiet stretch, though the Metro Venetian attack from Monday night remains unattributed and JMIC's most recent update (8/25) documented continued IRGC harassment activity short of a confirmed strike. [DEVELOPING] Transit data still splits by vendor: PortWatch's latest (Aug 23) puts throughput at 4% of the pre-crisis baseline, while Kpler counted 121 weekly crossings 17-23 Aug, essentially flat week-on-week — a divergence this issue can't reconcile any better than the last one did, since the

two trackers count different populations over different windows (see Board). The dark-tanker share (27% of a larger, 240-vessel screened population) isn't directly comparable to prior issues' smaller samples. No fresher status on the detained tanker Amara was located this run; its hold past Aug. 21 remains unconfirmed.

SPORTS

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Continuity. Weekend edition: Metrics/Calendar condensed to two lines each per format; Economics and Technology cut — nothing broke beyond what's already carried in the Lead and Business. Dropped as unchanged since 8/27: Khamenei/IRGC command reshuffle, TSMC July revenue, Microsoft's Maia chip orders, Araghchi's rhetorical framing, the House-Senate funding gap, Oman-Iran talks (no new readout), Amara's status.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.